

government schemes in the rural parts of India," said Tata Consultancy Services MD & CEO K Krithivasan.

With AI Sakhi, TCS aims to break key barriers in AI adoption, said Krithivasan. "AI programming has been the forte of people who are comfortable in English. Now what we are doing is teaching people from non-English-speaking background on how they can use AI and develop software," the TCS CEO explained.

Smriti Irani, former Union minister and founder and chairperson of Alliance for Global Good, lauded the initiative. "Women from across the country have been represented in the AI Sakhi Immersion programme, which helps women identify the use case of AI for their small businesses," Irani said, adding that the programme breaks age barriers as most of these women are above the age of 35.

AI-led design creation in jewelry is helping women artisans from rural India improve their livelihoods and grow their businesses, said Aarthi Subramanian, ED–President and Chief Operating Officer, TCS. "The Tata AI Sakhi programme is aimed at bringing AI to the hands of rural women. These are entrepreneurs who are providing last-mile support in the villages. These are karigars who are designing fashion jewelry. The whole thinking is how can AI empower them and help them in their daily lives," Subramanian added.

AI can be used by everyone for solving day-to-day problems, Union Minister of Electronics and IT Ashwini Vaishnaw said at the Tata Bharat YUVAi Hackathon, an event organised by Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) aimed at empowering around 2,000 non-engineering undergraduates — many without prior coding experience—to use voice-first, multilingual AI tools to build solutions for sectors such as healthcare, education, agriculture, and civic services.

The TCS YUVAi Hackathon is designed to democratise AI learning, said Krithivasan. "We want to make AI learning accessible to every student, not only for engineers. We believe AI empowers all, not just the engineers, and that's the idea of this hackathon. We intend to scale this programme to reach 1 million students over the next few months."

Ashok Krish, VP & Head, AI Practices, TCS, called it the world's largest hackathon for non-coders. "We deliberately picked college students who have never coded in their lives. We are telling them you can build technology. AI will help you do that. The more important thing is knowing what problem to solve," said Krish.

"In 2 hours, 2,000 students discovered something that they knew they couldn't do: go from a problem statement to a working application in under 2 hours. Everybody thinks you need a developer, a team of engineer and a lot of expensive technology to do it," Krish highlighted.

